

KSUM **NEWSLETTER**

January 2024

www.startupmission.kerala.gov.in

Kerala has around 5000 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

JANUARY 2024 EVENTS

BEST PERFORMER



Kerala has been honoured as the Best Performer State by Startup India Rankings 2022 by DPIIT! This award acknowledges Kerala's commendable efforts in establishing a robust startup ecosystem, marked by being a capacity-building pioneer, funding leader, procurement forerunner, sustainability promoter, incubation hub, mentorship champion, innovative leader, and institutional champion. The state's continued dedication to innovation and inclusive growth has solidified its position as a leading startup destination in India.

UK ROYAL NAVY, BRITISH HIGH COMMISSION OFFICIALS AND CHEVENING ALUMNI VISIT ISC



Kerala Startup Mission had the distinct honour of hosting distinguished representatives from the UK Royal Navy, British High Commission, and Chevening Alumni at Integrated Startup Complex (ISC), Kochi. The visit emphasised the importance of international partnerships in driving entrepreneurship and innovation.

WOMEN IN STEM AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP CREATING LEADERS PROGRAM HOSTED BY THE BRITISH HIGH COMMISSION AND KSUM WITH THE (UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD)AND CHEVENING ALUMNI



Excited to host the Women in STEM and Entrepreneurship creating Leaders Program in collaboration with the British High Commission, the University of Oxford, and Chevening Alumni at Kochi. The event was an incredible opportunity to emphasize the vital role women play in the future development of STEM fields. Participants had the chance to explore the incredible insights shared by Oxford Alumni & Chevening Fellows, paving the way for a brighter future in STEM careers.



VISIT OF MEITY AT KSUM KOCHI



Honoured to host Shri S Krishnan, IAS, Secretary to the Government of India, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and esteemed delegates at KSUM's Integrated Startup Complex (ISC), Kochi.





WESTART KICK OFF ■■■■■

The WE Start Kick-off event on December 29th, 2023, featured speakers - Vinitha Joseph, Founder & CEO, BluePurple Management Consulting Private Ltd, Neha Susan Manoj, Technology Fellow, Women Entrepreneurship Development, Kerala Startup Mission, and Adithya S V, Assistant Manager, Kerala Startup Mission.

The initiative, launched by Kerala Startup Mission, aims to support aspiring women entrepreneurs by providing resources like incubation facilities, funding, mentorship programs, networking events, and skill development workshops.



FAB ACADEMY 2024 BEGAN AT SUPER FABLAB KOCHI ■■■■■



The inaugural session of Fab Academy 2024 at Super Fablab Kochi marked a promising beginning. This year, our cohort comprises 10 students, notably including 5 accomplished women recipients of the Women Maker Scholarship, a commendable initiative by the Kerala Startup Mission. Diverse in their academic backgrounds, these students embody the program's commitment to fostering talent from various disciplines. Fablab Kerala, through Fab Academy, aspires to cultivate a pool of skilled innovators, contributing significantly to the state's progression towards establishing a robust Knowledge Economy.



CONGRATULATIONS INTERNATIONAL VIRTUAL ASSISTANCE PVT LTD (IVA)



Congratulations International Virtual Assistance Pvt Ltd (IVA), for being recognized as the "Best Research Company in AI" at the Global Artificial Intelligence Summit and Awards 2024 (GAISA), hosted by AICRA. IVA, a KSUM-based AI startup, specialises in machine learning, signal processing, pattern recognition, and computer vision. Their commitment to innovation is bolstered by strategic partnerships with institutes like the Indian Institute of Technology and the National Institute of Technology.



FOUNDERS MEET AT PALAKKAD IIT



The 15th edition of Founders Meet, held on 12th January 2024 at Palakkad IIT, was a success, bringing together prominent startup figures to exchange ideas and experiences. Distinguished speakers, including Anoop Ambika (CEO of Kerala Startup Mission), A. Sheshadri Shekar (Director of Palakkad IIT), Ravindran P.M. (Managing Director of Palakkad Surgical Industries), Rahul P Balachandran (CEO of Inker Robotics), Rajesh Malamal (Ex-Co-founder of Watasale, CGO at Estro Tech Robotics), and Anoop Balakrishnan (Product Owner at Omnichannel Retail Bigbasket), shared invaluable insights. Attendees connected with industry leaders, gaining crucial insights for their startup journey. The event successfully cultivated a vibrant network of founders, providing a platform to navigate challenges across various stages of growth.



INNOVATION TOUR - JANUARY 2024



On January 6, 2024, the event Innovation Tour was held at Kerala Technology Innovation Zone. The tour highlighted KTIZ's startup support and featured a Chartered Accountant session on Startup Registration steps. Speakers covered funding, investments, and Maker Village opportunities, enriching diverse entrepreneurs with practical insights in a condensed format.



FACULTY DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME ON AI & ML RESEARCH APPLICATIONS IN ISC KOCHI

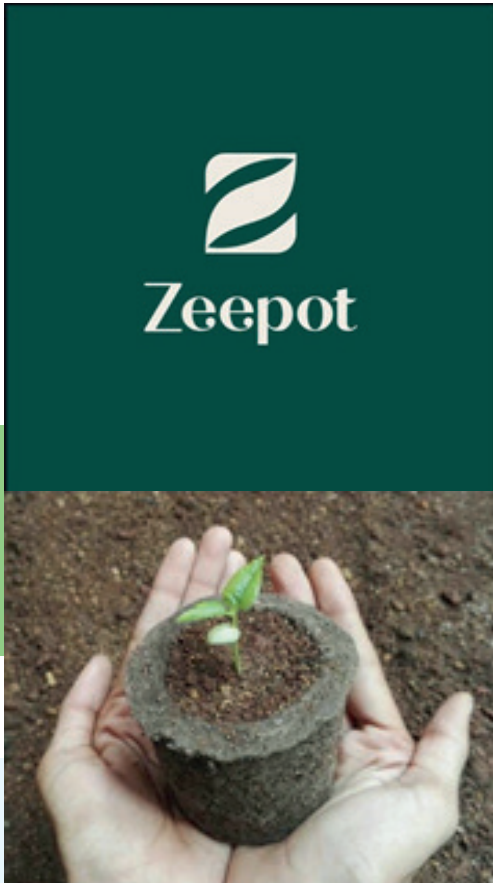


On January 12, 2024, a Faculty Development Programme on AI & ML Research Applications took place at ISC. The session included an overview of KSUM and its schemes, a presentation by Maker Village explaining its purpose, and interactions with AI startups Zappyhire and Algorithmia. The event concluded with a campus tour, exploring Maker Village and Fablab.



IEDC PROJECT OF THE MONTH

ZEEPOT INNOVATIONS: NIDA MEHAR'S GREEN REVOLUTION



Nida Mehar, the dynamic 22-year-old founder and CEO of Zeepot Innovations, is spearheading a sustainable agriculture movement with her groundbreaking product, Zeepot. Raised in Kerala's Malappuram district, Nida's deep connection with nature propels her mission to tackle plastic pollution at its roots. Zeepot, an all-natural and biodegradable grow pot, is positioned to transform the agricultural landscape by replacing plastic growbags and promoting eco-friendly farming practices.

In confronting the escalating issue of plastic pollution, Nida emphasizes crucial statistics that underscore the urgency for innovative solutions, especially in plastic-affected states like Kerala. She advocates for a paradigm shift, focusing on eliminating plastic from production rather than mere reduction, reuse, or recycling.

Zeepot, aptly dubbed "Everything a Plant Needs," is crafted from a blend of cow dung and seven natural materials. Nida outlines nine compelling reasons why Zeepot makes ecological sense, ranging from zero waste in manufacturing and usage to aiding forestation and boosting farmers' income. The product not only addresses environmental concerns but also fosters sustainable agriculture.

The journey of Zeepot began with Nida's passion for gardening and her aversion to discarding traditional growbags. Rejected initially, her determination only strengthened. Winning the title at the "All Kerala Science Exhibition" marked a pivotal moment, providing her with the confidence to forge ahead with Zeepot.

Looking forward, Nida envisions Zeepot Innovations evolving into a multinational company with an expanded product line. Beyond business success, her vision encompasses creating awareness about plastic pollution, mentoring children, inspiring students, uplifting women, and launching 'Smiling Shore'—an initiative to clean up Indian beaches, requiring a dedicated team.

Zeepot Innovations aims to empower women by providing better employment opportunities, fostering a supportive ecosystem for personal and professional growth. Nida's commitment echoes her belief in the pivotal role women play in driving positive change.

In conclusion, Nida Mehar's Zeepot Innovations embodies a commitment to sustainable farming, environmental consciousness, and gender empowerment. Her journey, alongside the pioneering efforts of WESAT, showcases the potential for innovation to drive positive change, paving the way for a greener and more equitable future.



RINK - EXPOSURE VISIT



Kerala Startup Mission recently organized an 'Exposure Visit' to the 'Institute of Advanced Virology, Trivandrum' on January 30, 2024. The visit, aimed at researchers and R&D startups, provided an exclusive insight into IAV's state-of-the-art virology labs. Kerala Startup Mission recently organized an 'Exposure Visit' to the 'Institute of Advanced Virology, Trivandrum' on January 30, 2024. The visit, aimed at researchers and R&D startups, provided an exclusive insight into IAV's state-of-the-art virology labs. Participants had the opportunity to explore IAV's

the "Innovation & Translation Facilitation Centre (ITFC)," which actively supports startups and industries in the field of Biotechnology. The event witnessed enthusiastic engagement and fruitful discussions. Attendees gained valuable insights into participatory research opportunities and explored the incubation possibilities at IAV.



RINK TECHNOLOGY OF THE MONTH

PAPER-BASED FISH FRESHNESS INDICATOR FOR PACKED FISH AND SHELL-FISHES

In response to the escalating demand for fish in global markets and the challenges posed by recent adulteration concerns, ICAR-Central Institute of Fisheries Technology (ICAR-CIFT) has unveiled an ingenious paper-based fish freshness indicator. As fish prices soar and online and retail markets flourish, consumers face uncertainties about the quality and freshness of their purchases. Traditional methods of quality assessment, reliant on sensory attributes or costly analytical approaches, fall short in real-time applicability. ICAR-CIFT's innovation, a dye-based paper strip, responds to volatile compounds generated during spoilage, presenting a visible color change. This not only provides consumers with an instant gauge of freshness but also empowers the fish processing industry and retailers to adopt proactive measures for delivering top-notch products. The result is a significant reduction in post-harvest losses and an industry-wide commitment to ensuring the highest standards in fish and shellfish quality. In a rapidly evolving seafood market, ICAR-CIFT's paper-based freshness indicator emerges as a vital tool, contributing to a more reliable and transparent supply chain.



To know more about this technology
write to : rink@startupmission.in



STARTUP 360 AT KASARGODE



The Startup 360 event at LEAP Kasargode, ASAP Skill Park, on January 31, 2024, was a success, offering a comprehensive exploration of business aspects for entrepreneurs. The event, designed to empower founders at every stage of their entrepreneurial journey, featured industry experts discussing strategic business planning, technical intricacies, legal essentials, financial management, and human resources. Speakers included Manu Francis, CEO of GHC GrowthLab, CA Sreelal Karimbi, Chartered Accountant, and Haris Aboobacker, Director of Haris & Co and Co-founder of HACA. Startup enthusiasts actively participated, showcasing the importance of Startup 360 events in empowering and connecting entrepreneurs across different regions.



GOVERNMENT AS A MARKETPLACE

KSUM facilitated 23 proposals for various Government Departments from Startups between December 2023 and January 2024. The Startup Procurement Committee sanctioned proposals worth Rs 5.45 Crores. Details are as follows

Technical Committee for December and January approved 23 proposals

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Hydrographic Survey Wing	Learning Management System	Infintor	4.8
02	Kerala Police	Drone Jammer System	Asnaviram Networks	58
03	Social Justice Department	Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act tracking software	Kawika	4.8
04	Additional Skill Acquisition Program	Talent Based Builders IT Platform & SEO for Corporate website	SRV IT Hub	9.5
05	Smart City Trivandrum Limited	Digitalisation of Waste Management	Nellikka	1
06	Smart City Trivandrum Limited	Flood Monitoring and Early Warning System	Tranquility IoT and Big Data Solutions Pvt Ltd	25.5
07	Divisional Forest Office, Kasargod	AI Detection and Early Warning System	Invendoi AI Solutions Pvt Ltd	3.83
08	Divisional Forest Office, Chalakkudy	AI Detection and Early Warning System	Invendoi AI Solutions Pvt Ltd	4.19
09	National Health Mission Kerala	Integration of Public Health Evaluation Tool	Coretip Pvt Ltd	6.37

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10	National Health Mission Kerala	Open Health Care Network for Kerala Palliative Grid	Pupilfirst Pvt Ltd	0
11	Suchitwa Mission	Social Media Campaign	Katha Infocom Pvt Ltd	1
12	State Animal Husbandry Department	Media Startup for Animal Husbandry Media Division	Redxell Media Hub	0.5
13	Kerala State Aids Control Society	Bloodbag Traceability and Citizen Interaction Portal for Promoting speedy, safe and voluntary blood donation	Bagmo Pvt Ltd	239
14	Kerala Startup Mission	Roof Top Solar Installation at ISC	Vatsaa Energy	115
15	Hydrographic Survey Wing	Web and App based Data Management Solution for Hydrographic Survey Wing – AI based e-governance solution	Gaude	18.34
16	Hydrographic Survey Wing	Broadcast Video	XR Horizon Pvt Ltd	4.95
17	Mangalapuram Gramapanchayat	Purchase of Sanitary Napkin Dispenser and Conveyor Belt	Floret Technologies	8.81
18	Kerala Agro Machinery Corporation Ltd	Development of Customer Service App	Metric Tree Labs	4
19	Kannur District Panchayat	Maintenance of exhibits in Science Park - Kannur District Panchayath	Museolab LLP	9.39
20	Kerala Police	Development of Clone-Free ID card System	Invotthink	5.59
21	Kerala Police	Development of Financial Fraud Complaint Tracking System	Kawika	9.8
22	Kerala Police	Software Version Up gradation and Patching of District Police Website	SRV IT Hub	3.5
23	Smart City Trivandrum Limited	AMC & Extended Warranty for Flood Monitoring & Early Warning System	Tranquility IoT and Big Data Solutions Pvt Ltd	7.31

Government as a Marketplace team also conducted 4 online workshops for Government officials from various organisations on the Startup Procurement process which witnessed active participation.

DECEMBER 2023 - JANUARY 2024

No of EOIs	14
Project Under Evaluation	12
Value of work orders	5.45 cr
Active EOIs	1

MENTORSHIP



MENTORSHIP STATS - JANUARY 2024

12

STARTUPS

9

MENTORS

17

INTERACTIONS



"My one-on-one mentorship interactions with the SimpleLogic team were a nice experience that triggered continuous learning and empowerment to identify the specific challenges they are addressing through the innovative technologies and was able to inspire them with confidence and offer practical insights and strategic advice to foster their technology commercialization."

Dr. Manesh Thomas

CEO, Manipal-Government of Karnataka Bioincubator

"Upon contacting the Kerala Startup Mission, we were swiftly connected with Dr. Maneesh Thomas. Through online discussions and an office visit, Dr. Thomas provided invaluable insights crucial for our project's progress. He introduced us to an interdisciplinary team of technologists, guiding them in visualizing and realizing our product concept. Dr. Thomas facilitated seamless communication, ensuring timely manufacturing of the equipment."

Aswin P Chandran

Founder, Simple Logic Automatic Tissue Dissociator



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Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

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